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Board may rule on Daily Cal's campus lease

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(*#_Company_Name_#*) BERKELEY, Calif. -- The Associated Students of the University of California Store Operations Board is expected to meet Tuesday to decide whether to renew The Daily Californian's lease.

The board could postpone a decision until next month if a quorum is not met. At least six members must be present for a decision to be reached.

While members of ASUC want to use the space for student service groups, Daily Cal staffers said the paper should be the sole occupant of the space.

ASUC President Jesse Gabriel, a Store Operations boardmember, said he wants to reach a compromise at Tuesday's meeting.

"I will be making a decision that is best for students," Gabriel said.

Gabriel said he is considering asking the board to allot some of the space to other student service groups.

He is also considering asking the Daily Cal to give more ad space to ASUC instead of taking away office space from the paper. The space is usually allocated to various ASUC sponsored student groups.

The Daily Cal already gives ads to ASUC as part of its rent.

Since there is a lack of space for student groups on UC-Berkeley campus, Gabriel said the newspaper must not be treated better than other student groups.

But Daily Cal staffers said Gabriel's plan to share the space is not practical because the plan would compromise the security of the newspaper. Staff members said the paper is already crunched for space because it employs about 150 students during the school year.

"We would like to retain our space in total," said Daily Cal General Manager Hubert Brucker.

The Daily Cal also seeks a rent cut.

"We would like our rent to reflect market rates," said Editor in Chief Rong-Gong Lin, II. "We are paying an excess of market rates."

But ASUC Auxiliary Director Tom Cordi said the Daily Cal's current rent is market value and a very reasonable price.

The lease for the Daily Cal expired July 31, and it has been operating on a month to month basis.

If the Store Operations Board decides to not renew the lease, the Daily Cal has six months to find other offices.

The Daily Cal has rented the sixth floor of Eshleman Hall since 1994, when former Chancellor Chang Lin Tien helped the newspaper return to campus.

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